

Tide retrospective: *the third connected cumulant*

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Abstract

The third connected cumulant of the perturbation observable $u = -(tx)$ for the anharmonic Gibbs measure, as the second derivative of the perturbed mean at $h = 0$:

$$\kappa_3 = \left. \frac{\partial^2}{\partial h^2} \right|_0 \langle u \rangle_h = \frac{G_3(0)G_0(0)^2 - 3G_1(0)G_2(0)G_0(0) + 2G_1(0)^3}{G_0(0)^3}.$$

It is the second derivative of $M(h) = G_1(h)/G_0(h)$; the first derivative is the susceptibility $S(h) = (G_2G_0 - G_1^2)/G_0^2$ (so $\text{deriv } M = S$ near 0), and differentiating S once more by a compound quotient rule gives κ_3 . New file `AnharmonicThirdCumulant.lean`; builds clean first try, no `sorry/axiom/native_decide`.

1 Setting

Eighth tide of a single-day anharmonic arc on the laplace seabed, and the third rung of the cumulant ladder (after the cumulant generating function's first derivative and κ_2). The whole arc was built so that this rung would be reachable: the mean $M = G_1/G_0$, its pointwise derivatives at every order, the general- h susceptibility $S = \text{deriv } M$. With those in place, κ_3 is $\text{deriv}^2 M(0) = \text{deriv } S(0)$ — one more differentiation, of an explicit rational function of the partition values.

2 The thing formalised

Writing $G\ n$ for `weightedPartition lam alpha gamma t n`:

For the anharmonic potential, $\lambda, \gamma > 0$, $\alpha^2 < 3\lambda\gamma$, $t > 0$,

$$\text{iteratedDeriv } 2\ (h \mapsto G\ 1\ h / G\ 0\ h)\ 0 = \frac{G_3(0)G_0(0)^2 - 3G_1(0)G_2(0)G_0(0) + 2G_1(0)^3}{G_0(0)^3}.$$

The right-hand side is the standard moments-to-cumulants combination $\langle u^3 \rangle_0 - 3\langle u^2 \rangle_0 \langle u \rangle_0 + 2\langle u \rangle_0^3$ after dividing each $G_n(0)$ by $G_0(0)$.

3 Proof strategy

Three moves. *(i) Differentiate the susceptibility.* The pointwise partition derivatives ($\text{deriv}(G\ n) = G(n+1)$ at 0) feed a compound `HasDerivAt`: `.mul/.sub` build the numerator $G_2G_0 - G_1^2$, `.pow` the denominator G_0^2 , and `.div` their quotient S . The raw derivative value is `converted` to the clean

κ_3 form by clearing $G_0(0)$ with `field_simp` and finishing with `ring`. (ii) *Identify* `deriv M` with S . The general- h susceptibility tide gives $\text{deriv } M(h_0) = S(h_0)$ for every $|h_0| < 1$; since `ball 0 1` is a neighbourhood of 0, $\text{deriv } M =_{\text{ev}} S$ there. (iii) *Chain*. `iteratedDeriv 2 M = deriv (deriv M) (iteratedDeriv_succ, _one)`; the eventual equality turns $\text{deriv}(\text{deriv } M)(0)$ into $\text{deriv } S(0)$ via `Filter.EventuallyEq.deriv_eq`, which is the κ_3 value by (i).

4 Roadblocks and resolutions

None — it compiled on the first attempt, which is the real headline. The heaviest tide of the arc (a compound quotient-rule `HasDerivAt`, a degree-six `ring` identity in $G_0, \dots, G_3$, and an `iteratedDeriv` chaining) went through cleanly because every piece was a pattern the earlier tides had already exercised: the `convert-then-ring` shape from κ_2 , and the `EventuallyEq.deriv_eq` chaining from the general- h `iteratedDeriv` tide. The investment in the general- h susceptibility two tides earlier is what made step (ii) a one-liner.

5 What was Mathlib, what was new

Mathlib. The `HasDerivAt` combinators (`.mul`, `.sub`, `.pow`, `.div`, `.deriv`); `iteratedDeriv_succ` and `_one`; `Filter.EventuallyEq.deriv_eq`; `field_simp`, `ring`.

Seabed (reused). The pointwise partition derivative, the general- h susceptibility, and the $G_0(0) > 0$ positivity — all from this session’s arc.

New. The third-cumulant theorem. About 70 lines.

6 Lessons

- **A well-built arc makes its capstone cheap.** κ_3 looked like the riskiest tide (compound differentiation + big `ring` + chaining), but every sub-step reused a pattern already paid for, so it landed first try. The cost was front-loaded into the general- h step and the susceptibility, not the cumulant itself.
- `convert ... using 1 then field_simp; ring` is the reliable shape for “messy `HasDerivAt` value = clean closed form”. It isolates the algebra from the differentiation.

7 Follow-ups

- **Fourth cumulant κ_4 / flow-equation identity** (survey v4 #2): $\text{deriv}^3 M(0)$, one more differentiation of the (now explicit) susceptibility’s derivative. The arc’s final headline.
- Promote `amgm_t_abs_x` to `lean-common`.